An error occurred on this slide. Check the terminal for more information.

The Challenge You Face

Time is Limited

- • You have a career, family, responsibilities
- • Traditional courses require fixed schedules
- • MOOCs have 5-15% completion rates
- • You want depth, not just surface-level content

Your Curiosity Deserves More

- • You're curious about complex topics
- • You want to ask questions, not just consume
- • You seek genuine understanding, not credentials
- • You want to learn from the best, not just anyone

What If…

What if you could have a real conversation with the thinkers who shaped your field,
explore philosophy with Plato, discuss AI with Turing, or learn engineering from da Vinci?

🧠

150+ Expert Teachers (10K Roadmap)

History's greatest minds, available whenever you have time. Scaling to 10,000 across 10 colleges.

💬

Real Conversations

Not videos. Not lectures. Genuine dialogue where you ask questions and get thoughtful answers.

⏰

Learn on Your Schedule

No fixed classes. No deadlines. Learn when you have time, at your own pace.

How This Fits Your Life

For Your Curiosity

- ✓ **Ask deep questions** – Get thoughtful answers from experts
- ✓ **Explore complex topics** – Philosophy, science, engineering, arts
- ✓ **Learn at your pace** – No pressure, no deadlines
- ✓ **Build understanding** – Inquiry-based learning, not memorization
- ✓ **Access the best** – Learn from history's greatest minds

For Your Schedule

- ✓ **Learn anytime** – 24/7 access, whenever you have time
- ✓ **No fixed classes** – Fit learning into your life
- ✓ **Pick up where you left off** – SAMWISE remembers your journey
- ✓ **Short or long sessions** – 5 minutes or 2 hours, your choice
- ✓ **No pressure** – Learn for the joy of learning

"Live as if you were to die tomorrow. Learn as if you were to live forever."

What You'll Experience

150+
AI Faculty
Scaling to 10,000

76K
Bibliotech Texts
177 faculty bookshelves

13
Encyclopædia Vols
483+ entries, 2 editions

20+
Live Products
Built in 4 months

Bibliotech

76K texts – faculty bookshelves, marginalia, AI reader

Singh Lectures

Interactive Khan/MIT OCW – interrupt, ask, debate

Symposia

4 formats: drinking party, Faculty Club, Salon, Debate

Apocalypso

Risk dashboard + companion book

Commonplace

Faculty marginalia on Bibliotech texts

Feed + News

Social timeline & faculty takes on current events

Book Club

Faculty-hosted reading groups with live discussion

The Castalia Ecosystem

Atlas Devices

Purpose-built compute for learning

- • DS, TriCorder, Classic, Sense
- • Inquiry Appliance – local AI server
- • Open firmware, no telemetry
- • Or use any browser – web-first

iNQ Cards

Physical knowledge artifacts

- • $20/mo subscription – 12 cards/month
- • Faculty, Expedition, Rare cards
- • NFC & bamboo collector editions
- • Scan QR or tap NFC → guided inquiry

Magisteria

Stackable micro-credentials

- • 10-25 hr micro-credential courses
- • Verifiable certificates (W3C)
- • Scholarly ladder: Apprentice → Magister
- • Specializations across disciplines

Encyclopaedia + Apocalypso (discover) → **Membership + Magisteria** (courses & credentials) → **Atlas + iNQ Cards** (hardware & physical artifacts)

Your Intellectual Path

Structured progression with meaningful credentials – explore a living map of knowledge.

Micro-Credentials & Scholarly Standing

Each micro-credential (10–25 hours) combines faculty lectures, hands-on assignments, AI tutoring from **SAMWISE**, and automated assessment from **Beatrice**.

Progress through a **scholarly hierarchy**:

Apprentice → Adept → Magister → Fellow

Earn titles like *Certified Magister of Knowledge Engineering* or *Certified Adept of AI + Philosophy*.

Map of Inquiry & Virtual Campus

The curriculum is a **navigable knowledge map**: cities are learning activities, regions are disciplines, paths connect prerequisites.

Explore it through **WorkAdventure** – an immersive virtual campus where you walk the Map of Inquiry, encounter Faculty, and connect with fellow learners in real time.

Unlock new areas as you earn credentials and build intellectual standing within the academy.

Specializations

PersonAI Companion

Tangible Portfolio

iNQ Cards – Knowledge as Artifact

The knowledge is the product. The physical card is the artifact layer. **Inquiry before naming.**

Monthly Card Packs – $20/mo

12 cards/month. Thick card stock, matte finish, line art front, QR system back. Scan any card to enter a guided inquiry across animals, plants, science, locations, and people.

NFC premium editions: tap with your phone for instant access. Collector decks available.

Collector & Artifact Editions

Laser-engraved bamboo cards and etched brass Magister medals – permanent artifacts that feel like Victorian scientific instruments. Bronze, amber, brass, leather.

The Castalia aesthetic made tangible. Perfect for your desk, library, or as a gift.

Faculty Cards

Darwin, Hypatia, Euler, Borges – scanning unlocks an AI conversation with that Faculty persona

Expedition Cards

Yellowstone, Amazon, Moon – cards unlock maps and missions on the Atlas of Inquiry

Rare & Collectible

Golden Ratio, Principia Mathematica – special editions become collectible knowledge artifacts

Real Examples

You're a Software Engineer

You want to understand the philosophical foundations of AI. You join a **Symposium** with **Turing**, **Shannon**, and **McCarthy** exploring "What is intelligence?" You ask questions, challenge ideas, and build deep understanding over 7 sessions—on your schedule.

"I've read about these ideas, but actually discussing them with the people who created them? That's different."

You're a Retired Professional

You finally have time to explore philosophy. You have conversations with **Plato** about justice, **Kant** about ethics, and **Nietzsche** about meaning. **SAMWISE** remembers what you've discussed and helps you connect ideas across thinkers. You're building understanding, not just consuming content.

"I've always wanted to understand these ideas deeply. Now I can, at my own pace."

You're a Creative Professional

You're Always Curious

Why This Matters Now

Lifelong Learning is Growing

The adult learning market is growing **15% year-over-year**. People want to continue learning, but traditional education doesn't fit their lives. **You deserve better options**.

Your Curiosity Deserves Depth

You're not satisfied with surface-level content. You want to understand deeply, ask questions, and explore complex ideas. **You deserve teachers who can match your curiosity**.

```
<div class="bg-slate-800/50 rounded-xl p-5">
  <h3 class="text-blue-400 font-semibold mb-3">Technology Makes It Possible</h3>
  <p class="text-slate-300 text-sm">
    AI has advanced to where <strong class="text-white">conversations feel natural</strong>. You can learn from the greatest minds in history. You can
    figures are possible</strong>. You can learn from the greatest minds in history. You can
    read about them, but actually discuss ideas with them.
  </p>
</div>
```

```
<div class="bg-slate-800/50 rounded-xl p-5">
  <h3 class="text-emerald-400 font-semibold mb-3">Your Curiosity Matters</h3>
  <p class="text-slate-300 text-sm">
    You have questions. You have curiosity. You want to understand deeply. You're not
    satisfied with surface-level content. You want to go deep. You're ready to
    you just need the right teachers.
  </p>
</div>
```

How It Works

Step 1: Sign Up

- • Create your account
- • Set your interests and goals
- • SAMWISE gets to know you
- • Start exploring immediately

Step 2: Learn

- • Browse 76K texts in Bibliotech
- • Watch Singh lectures – interrupt anytime
- • Join Symposia (4 social formats)
- • Read Commonplace, Feed + News

Step 3: Grow

- • SAMWISE remembers your journey
- • Build understanding over time
- • Earn micro-credentials
- • Join a community of learners

It's that simple. You start learning immediately, on your schedule, with the teachers who can truly inspire you.

No contracts. Cancel anytime. Learn for the joy of learning.

Pricing That Makes Sense

🆓

Free Tier

$0

Explore and discover

- ✓ Articles & recommendations
- ✓ Community access
- ✓ Limited Faculty conversations
- ✓ Browse the Encyclopædia & Bibliotech
- ✓ No credit card required

🎓

Membership

$49/mo

Full access

- ✓ All 150+ Faculty (10K roadmap)
- ✓ Bibliotech, Singh, Symposia (4 formats)
- ✓ Commonplace, Feed, News, Book Club
- ✓ 1:1 SAMWISE tutor & Magisteria
- ✓ Micro-credential certificates

🎴

iNQ Cards

$20/mo

Add-on or standalone

- ✓ 12 physical cards/month
- ✓ Faculty & Expedition series
- ✓ NFC collector editions extra
- ✓ Bamboo & metal artifacts
- ✓ QR, NFC, or URL – same knowledge

Imagine Your Learning Journey

Here's what learning with Castalia could look like:

R

Software Engineer, 42

Scenario

"I've always wanted to understand the philosophical foundations of AI. I joined a Symposium with Turing, Shannon, and McCarthy, and it was incredible. These aren't chatbots—they actually know their work. I'm learning more here than I did in my master's program."

M

Retired Teacher, 68

Scenario

"I finally have time to explore philosophy deeply. Having conversations with Plato, Kant, and Nietzsche has been transformative. SAMWISE remembers what we've discussed and helps me connect ideas. This is how I always wanted to learn."

J

Creative Director, 35

Scenario

"I wanted to understand the history of my craft. Exploring literature with Shakespeare, art with Picasso, and music

A

Curious Professional, 29

Scenario

"I have questions about everything. I can explore science with Einstein, engineering with da Vinci, and philosophy

Your Concerns, Addressed

"I don't have time for another course"

Perfect. This isn't a course with deadlines. You learn when you have time—5 minutes or 2 hours, your choice. SAMWISE remembers where you left off, so you can pick up anytime.

"I've tried MOOCs—they don't work"

We're different. This isn't video lectures or quizzes. This is active learning through conversation. You ask questions, get answers, and build understanding—not just consume content.

"I want depth, not surface-level"

Exactly. Our Faculty know everything they ever wrote. You can explore complex topics deeply, ask follow-up

"Is this worth the cost?"

Absolutely. For less than the cost of one university course, you get unlimited access to 150+ expert teachers (scaling to 10,000). Try it free for 14 days— no risk, no commitment.

The Team Behind This

Daniel McShan, PhD

Founder / Custodian

- **PhD Computational Biosciences** (CU Med)
- **25+ years NASA**: Orion, Mars Phoenix, Stardust
- Lifelong learner and educator
- Built this to continue his own learning journey

Why This Matters to Me

As a lifelong learner, I understand the challenges of continuing to learn while managing a career and life. You want depth, you want to ask questions, you want the best teachers. This platform gives you access to the greatest minds in history—on your schedule.

```
<div class="bg-slate-800/50 rounded-xl p-5">
  <h3 class="text-sm font-semibold mb-2 text-
  <p class="text-xs text-slate-400">
    20+ live products, 76K texts, 13-volume e
    built solo using AI-augmented development
    for adult learners: flexible scheduling,
  </p>
</div>
```

What Happens Next

Step 1: Try It Free

- • 14-day free trial
- • No credit card required
- • Set up your learning profile
- • Explore with SAMWISE

Step 2: Start Learning

- • Have conversations with Faculty
- • Join Symposia and Salons
- • Ask questions, explore ideas
- • Learn on your schedule

Step 3: Continue Growing

- • Subscribe if it works for you
- • Cancel anytime, no questions
- • Join our community
- • Share your learning journey

We're confident you'll love learning with history's greatest teachers. That's why we offer a 14-day free trial—no risk, no commitment, just see if it works for you.

No contracts. Cancel anytime. Learn for the joy of learning.

An Invitation, Not a Sales Pitch

We're not asking you to buy a product.

We're inviting you to continue your intellectual journey with the greatest teachers in history.

To learn on your schedule, at your pace, with teachers who can truly inspire you.

To feed your curiosity for the rest of your life.

"I have no special talents. I am only passionately curious."

– Albert Einstein

Start Your Free Trial

Continue your intellectual journey with history's greatest teachers.

🚀

Start Free Trial

castalia.institute/signup

🌐

Explore the Platform

castalia.institute

Bibliotech · Singh · Symposia · Encyclopaedia · Apocalypso · Book Club

📧

Questions?

custodian@castalia.institute

Castalia Institute is building a new kind of educational platform—one that makes history's